

Introduction

Hyperchlorhydria; Increased gastric acidity. Gastritis or Hyper-acidity. Kind of a disease caused by the excessive increase in the sour attribute of *pitta*. It is of two types viz. *Ūrdhvaga* (moving upwards) and *adhoga* (moving downwards). It is characterized by indigestion, fatigue, nausea, bitter and sour eructation, heaviness, burning sensation in the chest and throat and anorexia.

If both *kapha* and *pitta* are predominant in the pathogenesis of *amla pitta*, then the patient suffers from bitter, sour and pungent eructation, burning sensation in the chest (*hrit*), upper abdomen (*kuksi*) and throat, fainting, anorexia, vomiting, headache, salivation and sweet taste in the mouth.

Acid reflux can be aggravated by many different things, including lifestyle, medication, diet, pregnancy, weight gain, and certain medical conditions.

निरुक्ति एवं परिभाषा (Nirukti and Paribhāṣā)

अम्लपित्तं चेति अम्लगुणोद्विक्तं पित्तम् ॥

C.S.Ci. 15/47 (*Cakarpāṇi*)

Amlapitta is a condition in which *Pitta* has an excess of sour qualities.

विदाहद्वयगुणोद्विक्तं पित्तमम्लपित्तम् ॥

M.Ni. 51/1 (*Madhu*)

विदाहद्वयगुणोद्विक्तं पित्तमम्लपित्तमित्युच्यते ॥

Ādd.Śa.Prā. 7/103

विदग्धं पित्तमम्लपित्तमिति ॥ S.Su. 21/11 (*Dalhaṇa*)

Amlapitta is a condition in which the *Pitta* becomes augmented because of excessive of increase of sour qualities.

विदग्धं शुक्ततां याति शुक्तमामाशये स्थितम् ।

तदम्लपित्तमित्याहुर्भूयिष्ठं

पित्तदूषणात् ॥

Kā.S.Khi. 16/9

Due to *Vidagdha* (improper digestion), the food becomes *Śuktatā* (sour or acidified) and gets

localized in the stomach resulting in *Pittadūṣaṇāt* (vitiation of *Pitta*) and produces the disease *Amlapitta*.

आम्लपित्त निदान (Āmlapitta Nidāna)

विरुद्धाद्यशनाजीर्णादामे चामे च पूरणात् ।

पित्तं स्वहेतूपचितं पुरा यत्तदम्लपित्तं प्रवदन्ति सन्तः ॥

M.Ni. 51/1

विरुद्धाध्यशनाजीर्णादामे चामे च पूरणात् ।

पिष्टान्नानामपक्वानां मद्यानां गोरसस्य च ॥

गुर्वविष्यन्दिभोज्यानां वेगानां धारणस्य च ।

अत्युष्णस्निग्धहृक्षाम्लद्रवाणामतिसेवनात् ॥

फणितेक्षुविकाराणां कुलत्थानां च शीलनात् ।

भृष्टधान्यपुलाकानां पृथुकानां तथैव च ॥

भुक्त्वा भुक्त्वा दिवास्वप्नादतिस्नानावगाहनात् ।

अन्तरोदकपानाच्च भुक्तपर्युषिताशनात् ॥

Kā.S.Khi. 16/3-6

Etiological factors of Āmlapitta are as follows : One who consume foods which are incompatible, rotten, sour; food substances which increases burning sensation inside; other factors which aggravates *Pitta*; eating before the digestion of previous meal; indigestion; manifestation of *Āma*; *Āma* develops at tissue levels; use of ground cereals (*Māṣa*); improperly processed wines & drinks; eating of heavy & moisture producing foods; suppression of natural urges; excessive use of hot, unctuous, dry, sour & liquid articles, consumptions of *Molasses*; *Kulattha* & sugarcane preparations; parched cereals; wildy growing rice and *Prthuka* (flattened rice obtained from boiled paddy); repeatedly sleeping in day time after eating again and again; over bathing; tub bath; drinking water in between food eating and consumption of stale food.

आम्लपित्त संप्राप्ति (Samprāpti of Āmlapitta)

वातादयः प्रकुप्यन्ति तेषामन्यतमो यदा ।

मन्दीकरोति कायाग्निमग्नौ मार्दवमागते ॥

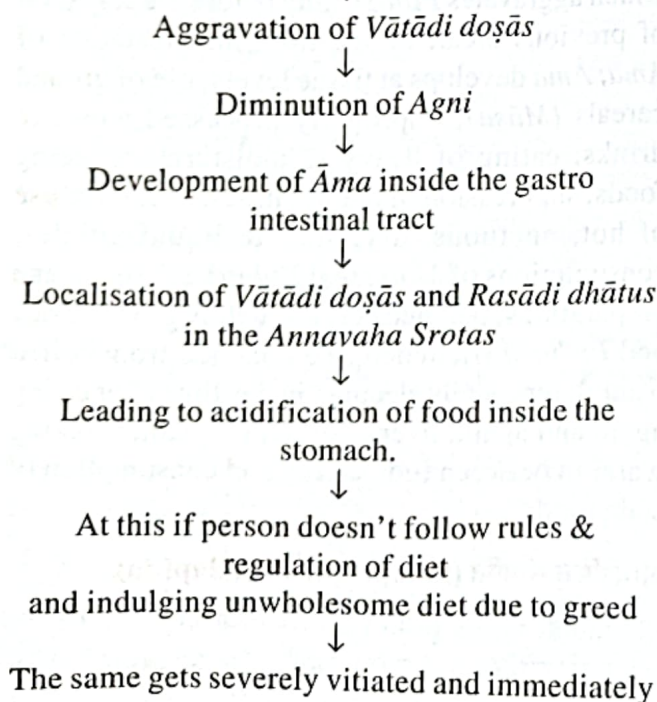
एतान्येव तथा भूयः सेवामानस्य दुर्मतेः ।
 यत्किञ्चिद शितं पीतं देहिनस्तद्वि दहति ॥
 विदग्धं शुक्ततां यादि शुक्तमामाशये स्थितम् ।
 तदम्लपित्तमित्याहुर्भूयिष्ठं पित्तदूषणात् ॥
 जन्तोर्दनुबध्नाति तौल्यादनियतात्मनः ।
 अविशुष्के यथा क्षीरं प्रक्षिप्तं दधिभाजने ॥
 क्षिप्रमेवाम्लतामेति कूर्चीभावं च गच्छति ।
 रसाघातौ तथा व्यम्ले भुक्तं मुक्तं विदह्यते ॥

Kā.S.Khi. 16/7-13

Due to above etiological factors *Vātādi Doṣās* get aggravated leading to mildness of *Agni*. At this time, whatever is eaten by an ignorant person, the same gets burnt, due to improper digestion, food gets acidified inside the stomach. If person doesn't follow rules & regulation of diet even at this stage and indulging unwholesome diet due to greed, the same gets severely vitiated due to pitta is known as *Āmlapitta*.

As the milk poured into undried & uncleaned curd pot, immediately it attains sourness & gets inspissated in a brush form, in the same way repeatedly eaten food gets improperly processed into *Rasadhātu* in case of *Āmlapitta*. When *Ajīrṇa* associates *Pitta* causes *Āmlapitta*.

Nidāna Sevana (Consumption of Etiological factors)



it attains sourness



The repeatedly eaten food gets improperly processed into *Rasadhātu*



Āmlapitta

आम्लपित्त संप्राप्ति घटक (Samprāpti Ghaṭaka of Āmlapitta)

Doṣa : *Pitta Pradhānatridoṣaja*
Vāta → *Samāna*, *Udāna*
Pitta → *Pācaka*
Kapha → *Kledaka*

Dūṣya : *Dhātu* → *Rasa*
Upadhātu → *Tvacā*
Śārīrikamala → *Puriṣa*
Dhātumala → *Kapha*, *Pitta*

Agni : *Jaṭharāgni*, *Dhātuvāgni*

Agniduṣṭi : *Tikṣṇāgnī*, *Mandāgni*

Srotas : *Rasavaha*, *Annavaha*

Srotoduṣṭi : *Saṅga*, *Vimārgagamana*

Adhiṣṭhāna : *Āmāśaya*

Udbhavasthāna : *Āmāśayottha*

Sancārasthāna : *Mahāsrotas*

Vyaktasthāna : *Āmāśaya*, *Kanṭha*, *Hṛdaya*

Svabhāva : *Cirakāri* & *Āśukāri*

Prabhāva : Newly manifested curable with difficulty & chronic disease curable with difficulty only in few persons.

Rogamārga : *Abhyantara*

Roga bheda : *Ūrdhvaga*, *Adhoga*

सामान्य लक्षण (Sāmānya Lakṣaṇa)

अविपाकक्लमोत्वलेशतिक्ताम्लोद्गारगौरवेः ।
 हृत्कण्ठदाहारुचिभिश्चाम्लपित्तं वदेद्विषक् ॥

M.Ni. 51/2

Āmlapitta is characterised by indigestion, exhaustion, nausea, sour or bitter eructations, heaviness, burning sensation in the chest & throat and loss of appetite.

अधोग आम्लपित्त लक्षण (Adhoga Āmlapitta Lakṣaṇa)

तृड्दाहमूर्च्छाभ्रममोहकारि प्रयात्यधो वा विविधप्रकारम् ।
 हृत्लासकोद्गानलसादहर्षस्वेदाङ्गपीतत्वकरं कदाचित् ॥

M.Ni. 51/3

Adhoga Āmlapitta is characterised by thirst, burning sensation, fainting, giddiness, delusion, downward movement of various kinds, occasional oppression in chest, skin rashes, diminished functions of *Agni*, horripilations, perspiration and yellowish discolouration of the body.

ऊर्ध्वग आम्लपित्त (Ūrdhvaga Āmlapitta)

वान्तं हरित्पीतकनीलकृष्णामारक्ताभमतीव चाम्लम् ।
मांसोदकाभं त्वतिपिच्छिलाच्छं श्लेष्मानुजातं विविधं रसेन ॥
भुक्ते विदग्धे त्वथवाऽप्यभुक्ते करोति तित्ताम्लवर्षिं कदाचित् ।
उद्गारमेवंविधमेव कण्ठहृत्कुक्षिदाहं शिरसो रुजं च ॥
करचरणदाहमौष्यं महतीमरुचिं ज्वरं च कफपित्तम् ।
जनयति कण्डूमण्डलपिडकाशतनित्तगात्ररोगचयम् ॥

M.Ni. 51/4-6

Ūrdhvaga Āmlapitta is characterised by vomiting, which is green, yellow, blue, black, slightly red or bright red colored sour substances, it resembles like mutton washed water, shiny, thin, followed by *Kapha*; patient vomits during digestion of food or in empty stomach, which is either bitter or sour taste associated with belching of similar nature; burning sensation in the throat, chest and upper abdomen; headache, burning sensation in the palms & soles, feeling of great heat, loss of appetite, *Kapha-Pittaja* fever, skin rashes, itching, surrounded by numerous small vesicles on the skin & other troubles to the body.

Classification of Āmlapitta based on Predominance of Doṣās

सानिलं सानिलकफं सकफं तच्च लक्षयेत् ।
दोषलिङ्गेन मतिमान् भिषङ्मोहकरं हि तत् ॥
कम्पप्रलापमूर्च्छाचिमिचिमिगात्रावसादशूलानि ।
तमसो दर्शनविभ्रमविमोहहर्षाण्यनिलकोपात् ॥
कफनिष्ठीवनगौरवजडतारुचिशीतसादवमिलेपाः ।
दहनबलसादकण्डूनिद्राश्चिह्नं कफानुगते ॥
उभयमिदमेव चिह्नं मारुतकफसंभवे भवत्यम्ले ।
तित्ताम्लकण्डुकोद्गारहृत्कुक्षिकण्ठदाहकृत् ॥
भ्रमो मूर्च्छारुचिश्छर्दिशालस्यं च शिरोरुजा ।
प्रसेको मुखमाधुर्यं श्लेष्मपित्तस्य लक्षणम् ॥

M.Ni. 51/8-12

Physician should be able to recognise the symptoms of *Āmlapitta* caused by *Vāta*,

Vātakapha, & *Kapha* because they are likely to create confusion to him.

Vātapradhāna Āmlapitta

It is characterised by tremors, delirium, fainting, feeling of pins & needles, general weakness, pain, feeling of darkness in front of the eyes, giddiness, delusion and horripilations.

Kapha Pradhāna Āmlapitta

It is characterised by expectoration of thick phlegm, heaviness, lassitude, loss of appetite, coldishness, general weakness, vomiting, coated tongue, burning sensation, loss of strength, itching and excessive sleep.

Vāta-Kapha Pradhāna Āmlapitta

It is characterised by the appearance of the signs of symptoms of *Vātaja Pradhāna* & *Kaphaja Pradhāna Āmlapitta*.

Kapha-Pittaja Pradhāna Āmlapitta

It is characterised by eructation having bitter, sour and pungent tastes, burning sensation in chest, upper abdomen & throat, giddiness, fainting, loss of appetite, vomiting, lassitude, headache, salivations and sweetishness in mouth.

साध्यासाध्यता (Sādyāsādhyaṭā)

रोगोऽयमम्लपित्ताख्यो यत्नात् संसाध्यते नवः ।
चिरोत्थितो भवेद्याप्यः कृच्छ्रसाध्यः स कस्यचित् ॥

M.Ni. 51/7

Prognosis of Āmlapitta- Recently manifested disease responds to treatment with difficulty; chronic *Āmlapitta* is manageable or curable with difficulty in few persons.

उपशय/पथ्य (Upaśaya/pathya)

In cases of *Ūrdhva Āmlapitta* where *Śleṣma* has high concentration one should try *Vamana* therapy. Similarly, in cases of *Adhogata Āmlapitta* where *Pitta* has high concentration one should go with *Virecana* therapy. After carrying out either of these therapies one should administer the *Basti* therapy. Apart from the above measures, one can include the following edibles in their diet: rice of old *Śāli* variety, *Yava*, wheat, *Mudga*, meat and

meat soups of wild animals and birds, cool boiled water, sugar, honey, *Saktu*, *Karkoṭa*, *Kāravellaka*, *Paṭola* leaves, *Hilmocika*, *Vetāgra*, well ripened fruit of *Kuṣmāṇḍa*, flowers of banana tree, *Vāstuka*, *Kapittha*, pomegranate, *Āmalakī* and all *Tikta* juices and edibles. One should also drink liquids which are anti-*Kapha* and anti-*Pitta*. (B.R. 56/156-159)

अनुपशय/अपथ्य (Anupaśaya/Apathya)

The following are strictly prohibited for a patient of *Āmlapitta*: fresh paddy, *Viruddhaśana*, *Pitta* increasing meals, obstructing the flow of vomiting, sesame, *Urada*, *Kulattha*, items fried in oil, milk of sheep, *Kānji*, salt, *Āmla* and *Kaṭu* juices, *Guru* products, curd and liquor. (B.R. 56/160-161)

MCQs

- Types of *Amlapitta*
 - 2
 - 3
 - 5
 - 6
- Which among the following is not a feature of *Urdwaga-amlapitta*
 - Mamsodakabhachardhi

- Bhuktamvidagdhe*
 - Karacharanadaha*
 - Kotha*
- तिकांम्लोद्गारगौरवैः is the feature of
 - Amlapitta*
 - Raktapitta*
 - Ajeerna*
 - Alasaka*
 - कण्डूमण्डलपिडकाशतनिचितगात्ररोगचयम् is the feature of
 - Uttanavatarakta*
 - Mandala kushta*
 - Urdwaga Amlapitta*
 - Adhogaamlapitta*
 - The term *Amlapitta* coined by *Caraka* in which chapter
 - Sutrasthana 25, Chikitsa sthana 15*
 - Chikitsa sthana 7, Chikitsasthana 12*
 - Sutrasthana 26, Chikitsasthana 13*
 - Both a & b
 - Which among the following is the types of *Amlapitta*
 - Urdwaga, Adhoga*
 - Urdwaga, Adhoga, Tiryak*
 - Sama, Nirama*
 - Koshtagata, Sakthagata*

Answer

1. a	2. d	3. a
4. c	5. d	6. a